A river bend is called a meander. Faster flow erodes the outer bank while slower water deposits sediment on the inner bank. During a flood the river may cut across a narrow meander neck, isolating the old loop as an oxbow lake.

A floodplain is the broad, low area beside a river. When water spills over its banks, it loses speed and drops fine alluvium across the plain. Repeated overbank floods build fertile layers and natural levees near the channel.

Karst landscapes form when slightly acidic groundwater dissolves limestone. The enlarged cracks can develop into caves and underground drainage. If a cave roof collapses, it may leave a circular sinkhole at the surface.

A glacier transports rock fragments frozen into its ice. When the ice melts, it leaves unsorted sediment called till. A ridge of debris pushed to the glacier edge marks its farthest advance and is known as a terminal moraine.

An aquifer is a layer of permeable rock or sediment that stores and transmits groundwater. Rain and snowmelt can recharge it where water seeps below ground. A well draws water from the saturated zone beneath the water table.

A lahar is a fast-moving volcanic mudflow made from water mixed with ash and rock. It can travel down river valleys long after an eruption. Pyroclastic flows are instead hot mixtures of gas and volcanic fragments moving close to the ground.